Bone Appétit

STEP-BY-STEP, CONDENSED

STEPS 1-5

1. Feed the stiff levain the day before (1:5:2.5); ripe in 8-12 hrs.
2. Mix everything but the salt and butter, develop the dough, then add salt and the butter in 4-5 additions until glossy and a full windowpane. DDT 74-76°F; add held-back orange juice only if the dough looks stiff.
3. Bulk: room-temp rise 30-40% (2-3 hrs), then cold retard 12-16 hrs.
4. Make the filling: whisk cocoa, powdered sugar, cinnamon, salt; add tahini, butter, emulsion, then juice a teaspoon at a time to a fudge-like paste. Press to a ~6.5 in puck between parchment; freeze 30 min or chill overnight.
5. Weigh out 130 g of dough for the bones and skull and refrigerate it. Roll the rest to ~11 in, set the puck dead center, and pleat the edge over it 8-10 times like a dumpling.

NOTES

◆ FOLD ALONG THIS LINE, TOP PANEL BACK — STANDS LIKE A TENT ◆

NOTES

STEPS 6-10

6. Pinch the pleats into one tight seam, twist, tuck, then flip the dome seam-side down on parchment and cup-and-rotate to round it.
7. Final proof 3-4 hrs at room temp until puffy with a slow, partial spring-back.
8. Size four bones with string laid over the dome (usually 5-6 in); roll, dent the ends, glue on with egg white along with the skull, and wash lightly.
9. Bake at 350°F (177°C) for 50-60 min; tent with foil at ~20 min. Done at 190-195°F in the crumb, measured ~1.5 in from the center.
10. Within 5 min of the oven, brush on two thin coats of melted butter, press on fine orange sugar, then sesame. Rest 45-60 min before slicing.

Full technique, troubleshooting & photos in the full recipe file · Bruce's Breads